thamesview

Your magazine from Gallions | gallionsha.co.uk | October 2008



Friends of Thamesmead Parks
Helping the community enjoy the great outdoors

Pride in Thamesmead Awards
Well done to our amazing winners

Great courses on your doorstep
Get qualified at the Southlake Centre

Inspector open day
Find out about becoming a Resident Inspector

Rent special feature
An in depth look at rent issues

Thamesview October 2008

kidsview

Gallions Housing Association

With this issue: Feedback from the Residents Conference 2008 and our Residents Annual Review 2007/0

tw magazine

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Thamesview takes you through the seasons

This issue of Thamesview celebrates the best of our summer successes and looks forward to autumn events and winter plans so there is plenty to keep you entertained.

With this edition you will have received a copy of the Gallions Annual Review 2007/08, which has lots of information about how we are performing and the service we offer to residents. There is also a booklet that shows you the ideas and outcomes from the Gallions Residents Conference in September.

In this issue we have the results from the Gallions Residents Board elections held over the summer and an opportunity for you to help us improve our service and learn new skills with the Resident Inspector scheme.

We have been in touch with Bexley Adult Education College to find out about the latest free courses available to you at the Southlake Centre in Thamesmead. There are plenty to choose from so you could try your hand at a fun new skill or get a qualification that could help you at work.

If you are looking for a great way to stay active and healthy through the colder months you can join London's very first Community Fit Club based in the heart of Thamesmead.

As always, there are great prizes to be won in our wordsearch competition and in Kidsview magazine.

Gallions Housing Association

FSC Mixed Sources

GRB GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD APPROVED

Park friends get messy



Thamesmead's new Friends of the Parks group completed their first big project in August, with a two day clean up at an overflow weir that connects to Southmere Lake. The group donned their waterproofs and removed two and a half tons of rubbish from the water and surrounding area.

The transformation was fantastic and families of swans have already been spotted flocking back to the lake. During the second phase of the project the group will be fitting bat nesting boxes and creating special log piles for mini beasts to make their home.

The Friends of the Parks group is made up of local residents of all ages and abilities who want to encourage the rest of the community to make the most of the amazing parks and open spaces in Thamesmead.

The group are currently planning projects, applying for funding and working with Gallions to improve and protect the local green spaces for today and for the future. The team meets once a month for an hour to discuss safety, facilities and biodiversity in our parks.

New members who are enthusiastic about conservation and community well-being are always welcome - contact Kelly Sullivan on 0208 320 3458 or email ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk if you would like to get involved.

Victory at the polls

We have recently welcomed some new faces to Gallions Residents Board (GRB) after an exciting election this summer. This was the first ballot for a number of years as even more residents wanted to make a difference in their community and join the GRB for the 2008-2011 term.

Our newly elected members, who will represent fellow residents for three years are:

Marlene Hunter, Ray Woodage, Maurice Bradley, Jim Flynn, Jova Novkovic, Dorita Sampedro and Michael Matthews. Jennifer Beecham and Adrian Gogerly were also co-opted for a term of one year.

Dave Jessop was re-elected as Chairman and Deborah Frimpong was re-elected as vice chair at the GRB Annual General Meeting at the end of August. Dave told the Thamesview team,

"I'm really pleased to be re-elected as Chairman and I'm proud that the GRB has made really positive progress as a group over the last year. We have some exciting plans for the future and aim to continue this success into 2009."

The GRB represent the interests of all residents and work with Gallions to improve services for everyone in our neighbourhoods. If you are interested in finding out more about the GRB contact Helen Chambers 0800 83 84 81.

The big five this summer



Gallions and the Gallions Residents Board have been very busy this summer, running lots of events for the whole community. These are just a few of the highlights!

1 A national Play Day event was held in Crossways Park this summer to bring adventure back into children's play. Lucky local youngsters were given the chance to go wild on bouncy castles, get BMX coaching and try out an inflatable human demolition zone. The activities were organised by a partnership of Thamesmead agencies as part of a series of Thamesmead Family Fun Days.

2 The Gallions Residents Board (GRB) held a series of fantastic Picnic in Your Park events in Birchmere Park throughout August especially for families with young children. Max the Lion made regular appearances and there were bouncy castles, slides, face painting and a children's disco to entertain the little ones.

3 Some of our newest residents in Slade Green enjoyed a Get to Know Your Neighbour BBQ in their communal garden in August. Gallions staff and the Gallions Residents Board (GRB) were on hand to help the new families and introduce the services we offer. There was some fun too with games, face painting and activities for the youngsters.



4 This August droves of Tavy Bridge residents took part in an annual fun day at the Southlake Centre, Seacourt Road. This year's theme was recycling and the environment. Residents were invited to take part in recycling races and a green quiz, with great prizes up for grabs.

5 Our Neighbourhood Wardens had a particularly busy time this summer, offering a massive range of sporting and creative activities for Thamesmead's young people. On Tuesday and Thursday evenings throughout August the team taught football, cricket, fishing and nail art to over seventy youngsters.

It's not easy being green

At the start of the year Gallions and other local partners joined forces to help Bexley Business Academy create a school garden for pupils to experience nature at first hand.

So far Bexley Business Academy students have been busy clearing and preparing the area and have been designing and making plant beds. The project will be completed over three phases, creating both vegetable and wildlife gardens.

We are currently looking for some local support to help this project (and the garden!) really grow. If you or your company would like to sponsor part of the garden, fund works, supply materials or just lend a helping hand please get in touch.

Contact Kelly Sullivan for more details on 020 8320 3458 or email ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk.

Inspirational Thamesmead people

Thank you to everyone who told us about great groups and individuals for the Pride in Thamesmead Awards 2008. We received some fantastic nominations and were really impressed by the positive contribution that the winners had made in our community. Congratulations to:

- Chris Ash of Blewbury House, winner of the Thamesmead's Greatest Neighbour category for her continued dedication and support of the Tavy Bridge Regeneration Residents Action Group.
- Friends of Thamesmead Parks, winners of the Best Community Group category for their enthusiasm and drive to protect and enhance Thamesmead's open spaces.
- Dave Jessop of Sunset Road, winner of the Biggest Contribution to the Community category for his passion and commitment to the community as a whole.

Our winners received their prizes at our Residents Conference last month – find out more about the conference in the feedback booklet included with this issue of Thamesview.



Free courses right up your street

Bexley Adult Education College is running some fantastic free Neighbourhood Learning Courses in November 2008 and in January 2009 at the Southlake Centre, Seacourt Road.

Whether you would like to learn a new skill or gain a qualification there is a programme for you. Pop along to the enrolment day on Monday 20th October between 10am and 2pm at the Southlake Centre to find out more.

A multi-lingual crèche is available during some courses and the Southlake Centre is fully accessible for disabled learners too.

- **Clothes Making**
- **Beginners Computing**
- **Floristry NCFE level 1**
- **Confidence Building**
- **Digital photography**

For more information about these Neighbourhood Learning Courses call Jas on 01322 552561 or visit www.adultedbexley.org.

Be the first to get fit

London's first Community Fit Club has arrived in Thamesmead!

Community Fit Club is a weight-management programme, which balances healthy eating, lifestyle change, physical activity and calorie control. The programme helps members improve their knowledge and skills to have a healthy lifestyle.

The club is based in the Atrium Community Centre, Middle Way and offers a weekly session on Wednesdays between 9.45am and 11.15 am, including a weigh-in, resource workshop and physical activity session. New members can join at any time, from £3 per week. At the session you will receive two free physical activity vouchers that you can use at centres across Thamesmead, including off-peak swimming at Thamesmere Leisure Centre and climbing at the cAve climbing wall.

To register your interest for the Community Fit Club, run by Bexley Care Trust and the London Borough of Bexley, contact Charlene Williams, Physical Activity Co-ordinator at Bexley Care Trust on 0208 298 6276 or email charlene.williams@bexley.nhs.uk.



Help when it's needed most

ARP (Alcohol Recovery Project) Tenancy Support and Outreach Services work with people affected by alcohol and drugs to help them keep their home, get treatment and develop the skills to live more independently in the future.

Specialist support workers offer a range of services designed especially for those with a history of alcohol or drug misuse. Help is available through one to one sessions with a support worker, community visits or telephone contact and you can choose whichever method works best for you. The service is free and confidential for Bexley residents who have an alcohol or drug problem and are experiencing difficulties with managing their tenancy.

You can refer yourself for the service by calling 0208 294 6797 or emailing floatingsupportbexley@arp-uk.org.

Environmental targets set

As part of our membership to ENCAMs, an environmental organisation that helps companies to enhance their local surroundings, we have created an action plan to improve parts of our neighbourhoods. We will be targeting five key areas in our community:

1. Graffiti – we will map graffiti 'hot spots' and remove graffiti from these areas more frequently
2. Litter bins – we will empty the most used bins more often and check if the bins are in the best places
3. Dog fouling – we aim to reduce the amount of dog fouling by 45% by 1st April 2009
4. Broken glass - we aim to reduce the amount of broken glass by 55% by 1st July 2009
5. Household waste – we will look at the differences in service between Bexley and Greenwich to see how this influences waste and work with the fire brigade to see if there is a link between waste and fire setting

We will monitor these plans regularly and tell you more about our successes in the next edition of Thamesview.

If you would like to find out more about how we are improving the local environment, contact Anita Dagger on 0800 83 84 81 or email adagger@gallionsha.co.uk.



Inspectors invited

Earlier this year Gallions and Gallions Residents' Board (GRB) started looking for residents who wanted to help improve Gallions' services and make a difference in their community by becoming a Resident Inspector.

Many local people registered their interest and helped us develop the scheme and inspection processes. We will be holding a Resident Inspector open day in autumn where you can find out more about becoming an Inspector and what the project will mean to residents and Gallions.

Contact Helen Chambers on 0800 83 84 81 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk to find out more.

SPOTLIGHT ON

Shaw Trust Progress2Work

The Shaw Trust has set up a great new drop in service at Trust Thamesmead that helps people get back to work.

The team are there to help anyone who is struggling in the world of work due to disability, ill health or other circumstances.

The Shaw Trust will help you write a CV, improve your confidence, get training and find a job, offering lots of support and advice along the way.

Pop in to Trust Thamesmead at 19a Joyce Dawson Way, call 0208 304 4196 or visit www.shaw-trust.org.uk to find out how the team can help you.

Local clubs and groups for all the family

Every issue we will be focusing on one group or service in the area. If you'd like us to shine the spotlight on what you do then please get in touch (details on the welcome page). Contact us too if you want to list your group or provide us with updates.

For little ones (under 5)

Goose-e-ganders parent and toddler group, Broadwater Village Hall, telephone 07958 640645

Toddles, Manor Close Community Hall, Manor Close. Term time, Monday to Friday 9.30am until 11.30am and 12.30pm until 2.30pm.

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School, Senior Citizens Hall, Tavy Bridge, telephone 07950 853481

Lighthouse Parent and Toddler Group, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Wednesdays and Fridays 1.30pm until 3pm.

Young Foundations Pre-School, Emmanuel Church Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Monday until Friday 9.30am until 12 noon.

Toy Library, Linton Mead Primary School, Central Way, telephone 0208 310 1902, Friday 9am until 11am, term time only, for under 5s.

For bigger ones

The cAve climbing wall, Arch 3, Harrow Manor Way, telephone 0208 320 4494, www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk, Monday to Friday 4pm until 7pm and weekends 1.30pm until 5.30pm, for under 18s.

Fun Club, Glimpsing Green, telephone 0208 311 6777, Saturday mornings, for under 11s with a disability.

JMF Support Group, Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path, telephone 0208 310 5885, Saturday 1pm until 3pm

Rainbows, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for 5 to 7 year olds.

Rainbows, Abbey Wood Community Centre, 4 Knee Hill, telephone 0208 311 2239, Wednesday 4.45pm until 6pm, for 5 to 7 year olds

Brownies and Guides, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 0208 310 2419, for girls aged 7+.

Brownies, Greenmead Community Centre, telephone 07960 815229, Every Tuesday from 6pm, Girls age 7 to 10.

New Acres Library, Tavy Bridge, telephone 0208 311 5291, for all young people, from babies to teenagers.

Hawksmoor Youth Club, Bentham Road, telephone 0208 312 4022

Heronsgate Youth Club, Whinchat Road, 07950 612826

Performing Arts

Dynamix Street Dance, Bexley Business Academy, Yarton Way, telephone 07594 286798, www.myspace.com/dynamix07, Friday 6pm-9pm, for ages 11-18

Dynamix Junior Street Dance, Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way, telephone 07594 286798, www.myspace.com/dynamix07, Friday 5.30pm-6.30pm, for ages 6-10

Theatre Street, Broadwater Village Hall, Gooseander Way, telephone 01322 441977, www.theatrestreet.com, tots to adults

Youth Advisory Project, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, telephone 0208 311 5111, for 16 to 24 year olds

Threshold Dance and Drama, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 07949 601935, www.thresholddanceanddrama.co.uk, different times for ages 5 to 16.

Young at Heart

Monday Club Bingo, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

Over 50s Bingo Club, Greenmead Community Hall, Lime Row, telephone 0208 311 0366, Monday and Thursday 7pm until 9pm

Pop in Parlour, Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s

The Atrium, Teeswater Court, telephone 0208 333 2002, 7 days a week. Fun and free over 50s keep fit classes run Wednesday 4.30pm until 5.30pm.

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

Events Calendar



There are exciting things happening in your area!

October 08

Black History Month Begins 1 October

Yom Kippur (Jewish) 9 October

Car Free Day 10 October

Car Free Day at Cutty Sark Gardens will be setting the streets alive with activity again. You will be able to take a car-free walk through the town centre and see Greenwich at its best. You will also find energising performances, stalls and displays around every corner, and have your say in the Talk Cafe. **Need more details? Contact 020 8921 4464 or email paul.lejeune@greenwich.gov.uk to discover more.**

Greenwich and Bexley Hospice Cycle 2008 12 October

Register to take part in the sponsored cycle along the Thames Cycle Path in aid of the Greenwich and Bexley Hospice. This fun event attracts almost 1000 cyclists each year so you will be in good company! There are 3 rides starting and finishing at Erith, Woolwich Arsenal and Greenwich. **Need more details? Contact Greenwich and Bexleyheath Hospice on 0208 319 9230 or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk to register.**

Chung Yeung (Chinese) 19 October

Halloween Children's Workshop 25 October

Go along to Charlton House at 10am to 11.30am and 12noon to 1.30pm to hear about the ancient British Festival that inspired today's Halloween rituals. Learn games of mysterious mayhem and make lamps, eerie masks and mobiles. **Need more details? Contact edward.schofield@greenwich.gov.uk or call 020 8856 3951 for further information.**

British Summer Time Ends 26 October

Half term Bexley and Greenwich Schools 27-31 October

Diwali (Hindu) 28 October

Events Calendar



November 08

Danson Park Family Fireworks Spectacular 8 November

Pop along to Danson Park to enjoy the biggest charity firework display in the South East, choreographed to classical music. There will also be a traditional funfair, a wide selection of food and beverage stalls plus lots more entertainment for families and children. **Need more details? Visit www.dansonparkfireworks.co.uk or call 08707 940 503 for more information.**

Remembrance Sunday 9 November

Christmas Craft Fair 15 -16 November

Get into the Christmas spirit early this year by visiting the fantastic Christmas Craft Fair at Hall Place and Gardens, Bexley between 10am and 4pm. There will be some great traditional gifts and crafts as well as modern items. **Need more details? Visit www.bexley.gov.uk to find out more.**

Santas on Broadway 23 November

Be part of something really unique this winter and help Greenwich and Bexley Hospice break a Guinness World Record™ for the largest gathering of Santas in one place!

For a registration fee of £10 per adult and £5 per child (aged 5 to 15) you will reserve your place in the Santa parade and receive your Santa suit for the occasion.

You will join thousands of other Santas in a festive parade and lead the countdown for the switching on of the Bexleyheath Town Christmas lights. **Need more details? Contact Greenwich and Bexleyheath Hospice on 0208 319 9230 or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk to register.**

St Andrews Day 30 November

December 08

Christmas Fair 6 December

Join Greenwich and Bexley Hospice in their new look Shornell's Conservatory, 185 Bostall Hill for a Christmas Fair between 10am and 3.30pm. With great gifts, books, crafts, festive items and much more on offer you might be able to pick up a bargain. **Need more details? Contact Greenwich and Bexleyheath Hospice on 0208 319 9230 or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk for more information.**

Christmas Family Workshop 7 December

Get all the family together and enjoy making traditional Christmas crafts at Hall Place and Gardens, Bexley. This is a really fun drop in session between 10.30am and 2.30pm, which adults and kids will love. **Need more details? Visit www.bexley.gov.uk to find out more.**

Christmas Celebrations in Thamesmead Town Centre 13-24 December

Trust Thamesmead will be bringing some festive cheer to the town centre in the run up to Christmas. They are planning a variety of activities for all the family. **Need more details? Visit www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk or call 020 8320 4470 to find out when Santa Claus is coming to town!**

Hanukkah (Jewish) 22 December

Christmas Day 25 December

Al-Hijra (Islam) 29 December

Just for Fun!

Have fun & win!

Take some time out to enjoy our brainteasers. You only have to complete the wordsearch for the chance to win a great prize.

1 Pub quiz

Enjoy this great pub quiz from the comfort of your own home!

1. What is Sting's real name?

2. When did the £1 note cease to be legal tender in the UK?

3. Who won the 2006 World Cup?

4. In the signs of the zodiac what is the symbol for Taurus?

5. Who invented the aeroplane?

2 Number match

Can you match these weights with the object:
15g, 120kg, 1.4kg, 1520kg

1. Baby elephant

2. The latest Ford Fiesta

3. CD

4. Cricket bat

Answers:
1. Garden Gnome, 1988, Italy, Bull, Wilbur and Orville Wright
2. Baby elephant = 120kg, Ford Fiesta = 1520kg, CD = 15g, Cricket bat = 1.4kg

3 Wordsearch

Autumn is a great month to get outside and enjoy the last of the sunshine for the year. Find all the words about the great outdoors in this wordsearch for the chance to win a £25 High Street voucher.

Leaves Fall Trees Fresh air
Walks Sunset Activity Colours

E	R	T	S	F	Y	R	T	E	A	F	A	H	E	S
R	H	D	R	S	H	U	B	A	H	A	F	T	N	W
L	E	A	V	E	S	W	N	I	E	L	W	O	E	S
E	L	R	E	D	E	R	A	O	N	L	F	W	W	D
N	E	M	E	I	N	S	R	L	E	F	E	S	A	N
T	C	C	H	I	S	H	Y	P	K	T	R	F	N	U
K	N	T	D	E	N	U	E	R	K	S	K	A	T	F
U	F	S	T	L	I	O	R	N	H	O	G	D	M	R
S	I	A	U	E	L	S	M	W	I	H	O	O	O	E
N	P	M	A	N	R	A	C	T	I	V	I	T	Y	S
V	O	S	H	U	S	F	E	A	B	E	A	D	A	H
E	E	E	O	G	E	E	E	T	T	E	N	E	F	A
T	E	L	A	T	Y	A	T	P	R	L	H	I	N	I
E	O	F	Y	B	D	S	O	I	T	O	R	Y	L	R
C	D	S	H	T	J	F	S	W	O	E	F	A	O	H

Please return the completed wordsearch with your details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH or drop it into our reception by 14th November 2008. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: .....

Address: .....

Telephone: .....

Email: .....

Congratulations to Mrs Wallington of Wren Path who was selected as the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

A Gallions rent special

In this special we tell you all you need to know about paying your rent and accessing rent related services.

Why should I pay my rent regularly and promptly?

It is important that we receive your rent on time. The money we collect pays for the services we provide, such as repairs and maintenance.

If you do not keep up with your rent payments we will take action to recover what you owe us and your home will be at risk.

How do I pay my rent?

You must pay your rent every week on a Monday. We understand that residents receive their income at different times so we accept payments on a monthly, four weekly or fortnightly basis as long as it is paid in advance.

You can pay your rent in six different ways:

Direct debit - Call us on 0800 83 84 81 with your bank account number and sort code and we will set up the direct debit for you. When there is a rent increase we will automatically amend the amount you pay by direct debit.

Standing order – Call us on 0800 83 84 81 or pop in to reception to pick up a form. You must complete the form and send it to your bank. If your rent increases you will need to tell your bank to change the amount you pay.

Gallions payment card - You can use your payment swipe card to pay your rent at any post office or shop displaying the Pay Point sign. Call us on 0800 83 84 81 to order a card.

Debit/credit card – Call us on 0800 83 84 81 at anytime with your card to make the payment.

Internet payments – Visit www.gallionsha.co.uk at anytime with your debit or credit card and Gallions payment card to make a secure payment.

By post - You can send cheques or postal orders to Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London SE2 9BR. Write your name and address on the back of the cheque or postal order. Cheques should be made payable to Gallions Housing Association.

Can I get help with paying my rent?

You can make a claim for Housing Benefit with your local council. The amount of help you are entitled to depends on your income, your savings, and the size of your family. Any money you are entitled to can be paid direct into your rent account.

If you are a new tenant, we will give you a Housing Benefit form when you sign your tenancy agreement. If you need help filling in the claim form just ask a member of staff.

Can I get help with my benefits entitlement?

We can help you understand and access the benefits you are entitled to. Call us on 0800 83 84 81 and we will arrange a free and confidential benefits health check at our office or at your home.

What should I do if I can't pay my rent?

If you can't pay your rent you should contact us straightaway. You can call us on 0800 83 84 81 or visit our office.

You can also contact the following agencies for independent housing and rent advice:

- The Thamesmead Law Centre at St Paul's Church, Bentham Road or call 0208 311 0555
- Housing Aid Centre at 125 Powis Street, Woolwich or call 0208 921 2618
- Citizens Advice Bureau at 50 Pier Road, Erith or call 01322 357933
- Citizens Advice Bureau at 8 Brampton Road, Bexleyheath or call 0208 303 5100
- Citizens Advice Bureau at Old Town Hall, Polytechnic Street, Woolwich or call 08451 202931

What will happen if I get into arrears?

We will try to help you manage your rent account and pay back any arrears but if you continue to have rent arrears we may:

- Refer your case to our Revenue Management Officers for legal action
- Deduct payments from your benefits
- Issue possession proceedings

What will happen if I continue to have rent arrears?

We will serve a notice of seeking possession if you continue to have rent arrears. A notice is the first legal step towards possession proceedings and possible eviction. Once the warning period of a notice has expired, Gallions can start legal proceedings to take back possession of the property if any outstanding arrears have not been cleared.

If you have a Starter Tenancy (Assured Shorthold tenancy) and you receive a possession notice for any breach of tenancy within the first year you will be evicted.

What will happen if Gallions take legal action?

We will go to county court to start possession proceedings. There are a number of possible outcomes, including an outright possession order, a suspended or postponed possession order or an adjournment.

If the court grants an outright possession order or the terms of a postponed or suspended order are broken, Gallions can apply to the bailiff at the county court for a warrant for eviction.

We will claim costs in all court cases. Gallions will only withdraw the claim if all outstanding arrears have been cleared by the time of the court hearing.

A person can be classed as intentionally homeless if they deliberately refuse to pay rent. A local authority is not obliged to re-house someone that is intentionally homeless.

Is there anything else I need to know?

We will send you a rent statement every 13 weeks to keep you up-to-date with your account. Your rent statement shows how much rent you are due to pay each week and how much rent you have already paid. It will tell you if there are any arrears on your account. Please contact us on 0800 83 84 81 if you would like any additional information about your rent account.

Your rent will increase once a year. This usually happens on the first Monday in April when the new financial year begins and after the anniversary of your tenancy commencement date. We will tell you about the rent increase four weeks before payment is due.

If you have any questions about your rent please call us on 0800 83 84 81, pop into our office at Harrow Manor Way, visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or email revenuemanagementteam@gallionsha.co.uk.

New Latest news for leaseholders

This section of Thamesview is especially for our leaseholders and it includes great information about our leasehold service. There are lots of ways to get in touch with the team:

Four weekly visits

The leasehold team are now carrying out four weekly visits in your area to make sure that you receive the information and feedback you need and to monitor and improve communal areas for everyone. We will be visiting you on the dates below:

School House Yard

10 October 07 November 2 December

Pinnacles

17 October 14 November 9 December

Thameswalk

07 October 04 November 03 December

Waterside Close

21 October 27 November 30 December

Paradise Path

21 October 27 November 30 December

St Joseph's Court

14 October 25 November 22 December

Contact Larry Lidbury or Sue Reed on 0800 83 84 81 or email leaseholdmanagement@gallionsha.co.uk if you would like to meet up during one of our visits.

Leaseholder surgeries

We run leaseholder surgeries at our offices in Harrow Manor Way on the first Thursday of every month between 10am and 12pm. If you would like to attend the next surgery on 6th November 2008 call us on 0800 83 84 81 to let us know.

Service charge meetings

If you would like to talk to us about your service charge account just call us on 0800 83 84 81 to make an appointment with Ian Da Nobrega or Janine Boyle. We can meet with you on a Tuesday or Thursday between 10am and 3pm.

Leasehold Forum Meetings

We run regular leasehold forum meetings at our offices in Harrow Manor Way where you can talk to us about any issues, comments or questions you have. We now have the meeting dates until the end of 2009 so get these in your diary today!

16 December 2008	7pm until 9pm
31 March 2009	2pm until 4pm
25 June 2009	7pm until 9pm
22 September 2009	7pm until 9pm
16 December 2009	2pm until 4pm

Acting neighbourly

It's great to have nice neighbours so follow our simple rules to help you enjoy your home and keep everyone in your block smiling. Remember:

1. Your neighbour might not fancy what you are having for dinner! Cooking smells at home are not classified as a statutory nuisance but please consider others when you are cooking
2. To keep noise levels to a minimum and consider your neighbour's lifestyle. Noise nuisance can be deemed as anti-social behaviour so think about the impact your music or TV will have on others
3. That dogs are not allowed in shared ownership properties

At Gallions we celebrate the diversity of our neighbourhoods. We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like this issue of Thamesview magazine translated into your own language please contact us. You can call 0800 83 84 81, email translations@gallionsha.co.uk or visit our office at Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. We can translate documents into any language and have audio, large print and Braille options available.

ਗੈਲੀਅਨਜ਼ ਵਿਚ ਅਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਇਲਾਕਿਆਂ ਵਿਚਲੇ ਵਖਰੇਵਿਆਂ ਦੀ ਕਦਰ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਗੱਲ ਬਾਤ ਕਰਨਾ ਸੌਖਾ ਬਣਾਉਣ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਰਨ ਦੀ ਮੁਫ਼ੀਕਲ ਸਹੂਲਤ ਦਿੰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਆਪਣੇ ਘਰ ਦੀ ਸਾਡੀ ਮਸਲੀਅਤ ਨੂੰ ਵੇਖਣ ਬਾਰੇ ਇਸ ਪਰਚੇ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਬਿਨਾਂ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ। ਤੁਸੀਂ ਸਾਨੂੰ ਨੰਬਰ 0800 83 84 81 'ਤੇ ਫ਼ੋਨ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ, ਜਾਂ ਇਸ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਈਮੇਲ ਭੇਜ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ translations@gallionsha.co.uk ਜਾਂ ਅੱਗੇ ਦੀਤੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਦਫ਼ਤਰ ਵਿਚ ਚੁਣ ਆ ਸਕਦੇ ਹੋ - Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. ਅਸੀਂ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ਾਂ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਿਸੇ ਵੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਵਿਚ ਕਰ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ, ਅਤੇ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਸੁਣਨ ਵਾਲੀ ਟੇਪ 'ਤੇ, ਵੱਡੇ ਅੱਖਰਾਂ ਵਿਚ ਅਤੇ ਬ੍ਰੇਲ ਵਿਚ ਵੀ ਦੇ ਸਕਦੇ ਹਾਂ।

Chúng tôi vui mừng vì sự đa dạng về dân cư ở Gallions. Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ dịch thuật toàn diện để tạo điều kiện dễ dàng cho quí vị liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn dịch số này của cuốn Tạp chí Thamesview sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị, hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi. Quí vị có thể gọi điện thoại theo số 0800 83 84 81, gửi thư điện tử theo địa chỉ translations@gallionsha.co.uk hoặc đến văn phòng của chúng tôi tại Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH. Chúng tôi có thể dịch các tài liệu sang bất kỳ ngôn ngữ nào và luôn sẵn có các lựa chọn khác như ghi âm, in khổ lớn và chữ nổi.

格莱昂斯房屋协會 (Gallions) 熱擁我們鄰舍地區的多元化面貌。我們提供全面的翻譯服務，以便他們與我們進行溝通。如欲要求我們把本期的 Thamesview 雜誌翻譯成繁體中文 (廣東話)，請告訴我們。你可以致電 0800 83 84 81、發送電郵到 translations@gallionsha.co.uk，或親臨我們位於 Harrow Manorway, Thamesmead, London, SE2 9XH 的辦事處提出要求。我們可以將文件翻譯成任何語文，也備有語音、特大字體和凸字版本，以供選擇。

Punjabi ◯ **Vietnamese** ◯ **Chinese** ◯

(Please tick one)

Name .....

Address .....

Return to: Anita Dagger, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association Harrow Mannor Way, London SE2 9XH.

Notice Board

Festival Prize

Thank you to everyone that visited us and Max the Lion on our Hawaiian beach at the Trust Thamesmead Community festival this summer. We hope you enjoyed the day as much as we did. Congratulations to Kim Page of Goldcrest Close who was the lucky winner of a Nintendo Wii after dropping off a prize draw slip from the July edition of Thamesview on the beach.

The Atrium is 10 years old!

On Wednesday 22nd October from midday until 4pm Gallions and Trust Thamesmead will be holding a party to celebrate the Atrium's 10th birthday. The event will, of course, be held at the Atrium and it is especially for residents that live in Teeswater, Shire and Buckwheat Courts. The team will be marking the occasion with a traditional sing-a-long, pie and mash and a raffle as well as information stands and a presentation.

Even more neighbourhood walkabouts

We have changed the way we run neighbourhood walkabouts to give you even more opportunities to meet with us. We will be visiting you street or block more regularly so yo can let us know about any issues you have and talk to us about our services.

Full details of the walkabouts are updated in our reception and on o website or you can call us on 080 83 84 81 to find out when we will coming to your neighbourhood.

Community Hall makeover

Members of Tavy Bridge Regeneration Residents Action Group (TBRRAG), Gallions Neighbourhood Projects team and the Neighbourhood Wardens, got together in August to give the Tavy Bridge Community Hall a much needed lick of paint. Thank you to everyone that took part and gave the facility a new look.

If you would like to get involved with activities that improve your local environment, contact the Neighbourhood Projects Team on 0800 83 84 81 to find out about a residents' association in your area.





A winning garden

Thamesmead in Bloom 2008 winners

Thank you to everyone that entered the Thamesmead in Bloom 2008 gardening competition and helped to make our neighbourhoods colourful and exciting places to be this summer. We received many entries from residents across Thamesmead and our judging panel visited some amazing gardens and balconies. Congratulations to all of our winners! Thank you to Tilfen Land for sponsoring all Thamesmead in Bloom prizes.

Celebrate with us

Gallions has recently won not one, but two, awards for our services and organisational direction. We received two top accolades at the London Excellence Awards 2008 for Leadership and for Making Partnerships Work. We are really proud to have been recognised for the work we do within our communities. The partnership award focused on our successful work with Axis, who carry out repairs and maintenance in your homes on our behalf.

Nominations to the Gallions Housing Association Board

Each year the Gallions Residents Board invites nominations from tenants and charge payers who would like to represent residents in the management of Gallions Housing Association.

All nominated individuals are assessed to ensure that they have the relevant skills for the role. Applicants are evaluated via a competency based selection process and interviewed by a panel that includes Gallions Residents Board members. The successful candidate is then nominated to represent Gallions Residents Board on the Gallions Housing Association Board.

The resident representative provides a direct link between residents and Gallions Housing Association and is involved in strategic decision-making.

If you would like to find out more about getting involved with what we do please contact Helen Chambers on 0800 83 84 81 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk.

Careers at Gallions

Details of our current employment opportunities are publicised on our website and at our reception desk. Please get in touch if you are interested in a career with us.

Complaints and contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A guide is available on our website.

Complaints@gallionsha.co.uk

www.gallionsha.co.uk

0800 83 84 81

Thamesview publication details

Thamesview is published by Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH and is free to Gallions' residents and anyone else who wishes to obtain a copy.

Thamesmead in bloom

Keep Thamesmead blooming throughout autumn and winter. Follow these simple steps to create a great hanging basket that will keep your balcony or garden bright and colourful.

1. Pick your favourite flowers from these winter varieties: winter pansies, primula, trailing ivy, heathers, dwarf conifers
2. Mix a handful of controlled-release fertiliser granules and some water-retaining gel into peat-free multi-purpose compost
3. Cover the inside of the basket with coconut fibre liner and lay a cut-to-size bin liner on top
4. Put a 2.5cm layer of compost in the base and make 3 cuts through the bin liner and fibre
5. Add your favourite plants, fill with the rest of the compost and water well
6. Enjoy some colour this autumn!

Team Gallions Environmental Services

Gallions Housing Association

, Harrow Manor
ww.trust-
Friday 4pm until
.30pm, for under

one 0208 311
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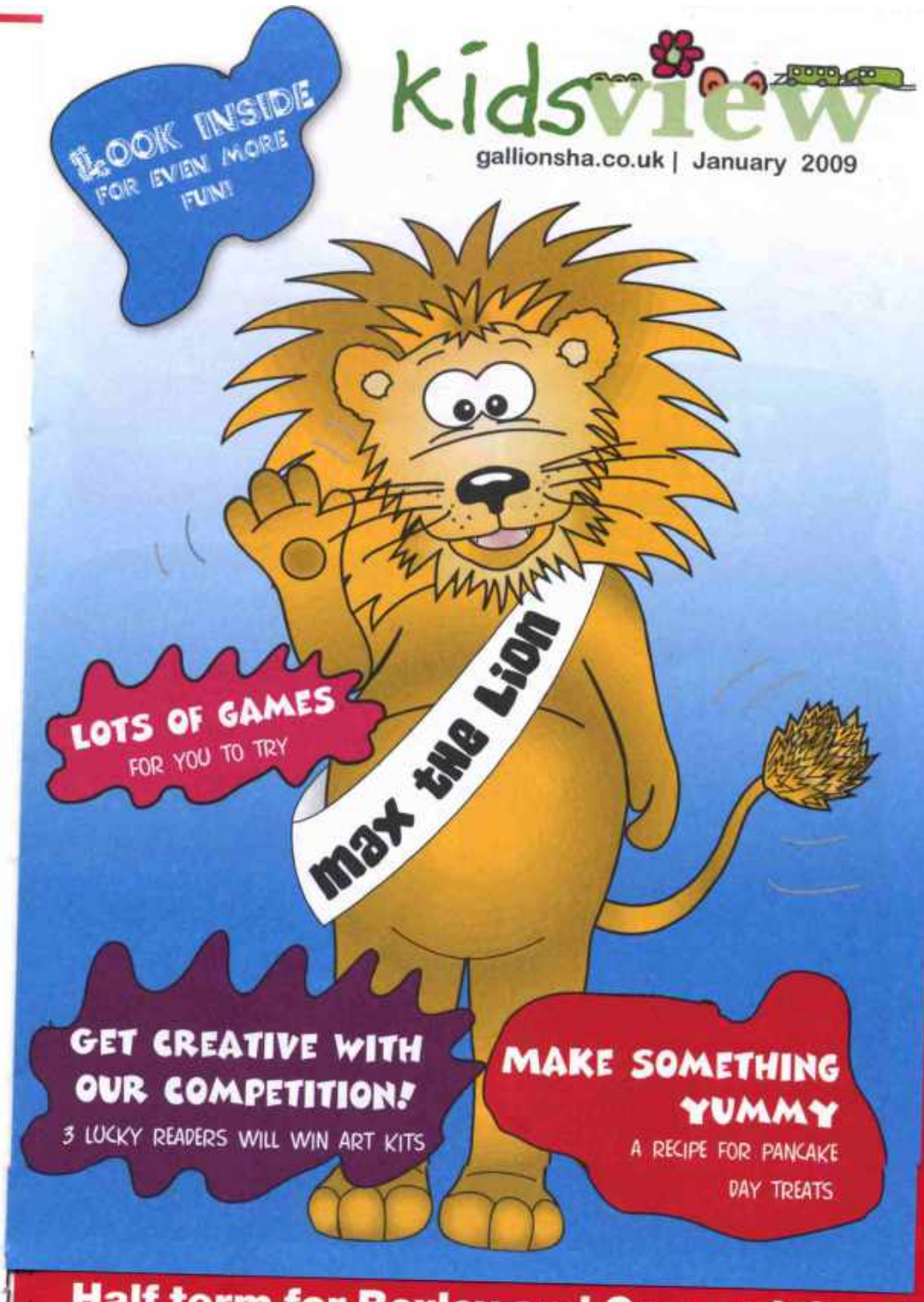
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Old Bexley Londo
www.walklondo

Half term for Bexley and Greenwich schools 16 – February

Shrove Tuesday 24 February

Shrove Tuesday is the day before Lent starts: the Tuesday before Ash Wednesday. Shrove T
sometimes called Pancake Day after the food we eat on this day. **Need more details? Vis**
pancakerecipes.net for recipe ideas.



HI!

HAPPY NEW YEAR!

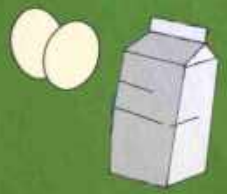
IN THIS ISSUE OF KIDSVIEW THERE ARE EXTRA PUZZLES, GAMES AND QUIZZES SO YOU CAN HAVE EVEN MORE FUN! THERE IS ALSO A GREAT RECIPE FOR YUMMY PANCAKES THAT YOU CAN MAKE WITH AN ADULT ON PANCAKE DAY. EMAIL ME YOUR BEST PANCAKE PHOTOS AT MAXTHELION@GALLIONSHA.CO.UK

ENTER OUR WORDSEARCH COMPETITION ON THE BACK PAGE AND YOU COULD WIN A BRILLIANT ART KIT TOO!

TASTY PANCAKE RECIPE

TRY THIS RECIPE TO MAKE SOME FANTASTIC PANCAKES FOR SHROVE TUESDAY! ONCE YOU'VE MADE THE PANCAKE YOU CAN ADD WHATEVER TOPPING YOU LIKE. ALWAYS BE CAREFUL WHEN COOKING AND COOK WITH AN ADULT.

INGREDIENTS



- 2 LARGE EGGS
- 150G OF PLAIN FLOUR
- 300ML OF MILK
- 150ML OF WATER
- 1 TEASPOON OF VEGETABLE OIL FOR FRYING

TRY ONE OF THESE YUMMY TOPPINGS TOO!



- CHOCOLATE CHIPS
- CHOPPED BANANA
- SLICED STRAWBERRIES AND ICE CREAM
- LEMON JUICE AND SUGAR

INSTRUCTIONS

1. SIFT THE FLOUR INTO A BOWL
2. CRACK THE EGGS AND STIR INTO THE FLOUR
3. ADD THE MILK AND WATER, STIRRING UNTIL SMOOTH
4. LIGHTLY GREASE A FRYING PAN AND HEAT
5. SPREAD 1 TABLESPOON OF THE MIXTURE IN THE PAN
6. COOK FOR 1-2 MINUTES, THEN LOOSEN THE EDGES AND TOSS
7. COOK FOR 1-2 MINUTES ON THE OTHER SIDE
8. ADD YOUR FAVOURITE TOPPING AND SERVE!

FINISH THE STORY

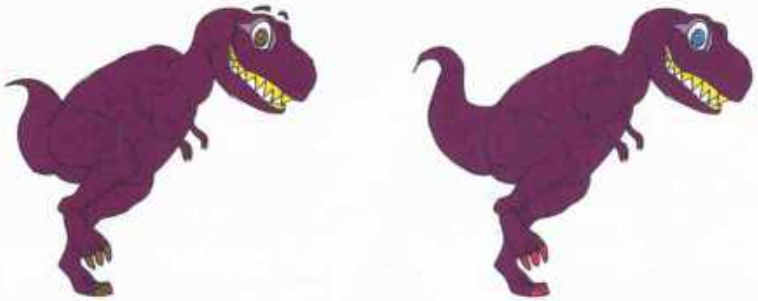
MAX THE LION HAS WRITTEN THIS FANTASTIC STORY ABOUT HIS TRIP TO THE ZOO BUT SOME OF THE WORDS HAVE RUBBED OFF! CAN YOU WORK OUT WHICH ANIMALS MAX MET?

WHEN I WENT TO THE ZOO THE FIRST ANIMAL I SAW WAS A _____ AND IT HAD A REALLY LONG NECK! THE NEXT ANIMAL I MET WAS AN _____ CALLED NELLIE THAT HAD REALLY BIG EARS AND A LONG TRUNK.

AFTER LUNCH I SPOTTED A LOVELY _____ WITH BLACK AND WHITE STRIPES. NEARBY WAS AN ENCLOSURE WITH LOTS OF NOISY _____ SWINGING FROM THE TREES. BEFORE I WENT HOME I SAW LOTS OF TROPICAL _____ SWIMMING AROUND IN A LARGE TANK.

SPOT THE DIFFERENCE

CAN YOU SEE THE FOUR DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THESE TWO DINOSAURS?



WHIZZY QUIZ

TRY THIS QUIZ – YOU ONLY HAVE 1 MINUTE TO COMPLETE IT! HOW FAST WILL YOU BE?

WHAT MONTH COMES AFTER MARCH? _____

WHAT IS 25 DIVIDED BY 5? _____

NAME 3 PLANETS IN THE SOLAR SYSTEM _____

WHAT IS THE CAPITAL OF FRANCE ? _____

ANSWERS
FINISH THE STORY – GIRAFFE, ELEPHANT, ZEBRA, MONKEYS, AND FISH.
SPOT THE DIFFERENCE - EYEBROWS, EYES, TAIL, TOENAILS.
WHIZZY QUIZ – APRIL, 5, MERCURY OR VENUS, OR EARTH OR MARS OR JUPITER OR SATURN OR URANUS OR NEPTUNE, PARIS.

Gallions Housing Association

Young at Heart

Monday Club Bingo, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton

Half term for Bexley and Greenwich s

& Enjoy!

TLIGHT ON

Discovery Child

Discovery Children's Centre especially for families and ch sorts of activities on offer fro baby clinics to interactive sto work and training sessions.

The centre adds new service regularly so there are always involved in. This month they w showcase training to help par and in February the bouncing you improve your baby's comm

Pop in and meet the team at D Centre, Battery Road, SE28 0J 4320.

l clubs, groups and ser

issue we will be focusing on one f you'd like us to shine the spotlig get in touch (details on the welc you want to list your group or pro

ittle ones (under 5)

e-e-ganders parent and toddl Hall, telephone 07958 640645.

es, Manor Close Community Ha Monday to Friday 9.30am until 11. .30pm.

es with Tavy Bridge Pre-Scho Tavy Bridge, telephone 07950 853

house Parent and Toddler Gr h Hall, telephone 0208 312 4700, Wednesdays and s 1.30pm until 3pm.

g Foundations Pre-School, Emmanuel Church Hall, one 0208 312 4700, Monday until Friday 9.30am until on.

ibrary, Linton Mead Primary School, Central Way, one 0208 310 1902, Friday 9am until 11am, term time or under 5s.

very Children's Centre, Battery Road, telephone 855 4320, Monday, Wednesday and Thursday 9am until and Tuesday and Friday 9am until 1.30pm.

note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held sible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

COOL COMPETITION!

It's Valentines Day next month and Max will be making some homemade cards for his friends and family. In this wordsearch Max has hidden six words about Valentines Day.

If you find all the words send your completed wordsearch and the entry form to us by 27th February 2009. The first 3 correct entries received will win a brilliant art kit!

C	E	I	P	U	L	R	O	N	F	I	R
I	H	T	S	H	I	C	O	G	L	T	O
O	W	O	S	A	N	A	R	E	O	U	O
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L	O	V	E	O	I	D	I	E	E	H	R
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D	U	L	A	T	E	G	E	E	E	P	E
F	D	Y	B	R	H	H	U	F	H	E	L

Heart

Flowers

Cupid

Cards

Love

Chocolate

Please return your completed form to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manorway, London SE2 9XH or drop your entry into our reception by 27th February 2009. The first 3 correct entries received will win a prize.

Name: _____

Name of parent or guardian: _____

Address: _____

_____ Telephone: _____

Congratulations to ALEXANDER HART who was selected as the winner of our last competition! This competition is open to children under 16 years of age and is free to enter.

Young at Heart

Monday Club Bingo, Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path off Titmuss Avenue, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm.

Over 50s Bingo Club, Greenmead Community Hall, Lime Row, telephone 0208 311 0366, Monday and Thursday 7pm until 9pm.

Rendezvous Club, Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s.

The Atrium Community Centre, Teeswater Court, telephone 0800 83 84 81, 7 days a week. Fun and free over 50s keep fit classes run Wednesday 4.30pm until 5.30pm.

Your invitation

Neighbourhood Walkabouts 2009

Every month we organise neighbourhood walkabouts where our Housing Officers get together with residents to check their street or block and see if any repairs, cleaning or improvements need to be made.

A walkabout usually lasts for up to an hour and you can come on your own, with your family or bring a friend. It's a great way to get to know your Housing Officer and other local people.

We would like you to join us for a walkabout in your area so you can tell us about any ideas or problems you have.

Broadwaters
Meetings take place on — Tuesdays, Wednesdays, Thursdays or Fridays
Your Housing Officer is — Aaron Nicholson

Crossways
Meetings take place on — Thursdays
Your Housing Officer is — Samantha Gibbs

Greenmead
Meetings take place on — Thursdays
Your Housing Officer is — Samantha Gibbs

Lesnes
Meetings take place on — Thursdays
Your Housing Officer is — Samantha Gibbs

Manorway
Meetings take place on — Tuesdays or Thursdays
Your Housing Officer is — Aaron Nicholson

Moorings
Meetings take place on — Thursdays or Fridays
Your Housing Officers are — Pearline Adams and Felicity Dunmall

Parkview
Meetings take place on — Tuesdays
Your Housing Officer is — Bho Thind

Southmere
Meetings take place on — Wednesday
Your Housing Officer is — Davinder Bal

Waterfield
Meetings take place on — Wednesdays, Thursdays or Fridays
Your Housing Officer is — Felicity Dunmall



Join in!

Walkabouts take place on different days and times and there are specific meeting places depending on where you live. Contact us to find out the exact time and place for your next meeting.

0800 83 84 81

Gallions Housing Association